

Tibetan Plateau

This high, flat region of Asia is surrounded by mountains. It's so high that it's often called the "roof of the world." The animals that live here have to deal with thin air and bitter winters.

Location

This region includes Tibet and parts of southwest China. Summers are dry and warm, and winters are often below freezing.



Asiatic black bear

This bear is also called the "moon bear" due to the pale, crescent-shaped band on its chest. It spends about half of its life up in trees.



HABITAT KEY

- Tropical forests
- Coniferous forests
- Tropical grasslands
- Deciduous forests
- Mountains
- Cold desert

Many kinds of plants grow on the plateau, including this serratula, a type of thistle.



Himalayan alpine serratula

Islamabad

This little relative of the rabbit is so suited to rocky ground that it often nests in a pile of stones!

Himalayan mouse hare

This large, cowlike animal has extra-big lungs that help it to get enough oxygen from the thin air.



Wild yak

PAKISTAN

The tahr is a wild goat that has hooves with rubberlike cores. These help it grip onto smooth rocks.

Himalayan tahr

New Delhi

INDIA

NEPAL

Himalayan wolf

Kathmandu

The Himalayan wolf is a rare type of gray wolf. Some are almost white—like snow on the Himalayas!



Himalayan marmots dig very deep burrows to hibernate in.

Himalayan marmot

Nicknamed the "Tibetan snow pig," this ground squirrel is one of the only mammals on Earth that lives above 16,400 ft (5,000 m).